

Probation and Onboarding Guide

For new joiners and their line managers

Document ID	HR-POL-005	Version	2.0
Effective Date	1 June 2025	Owner	People Operations
Classification	Internal	Supersedes	HR-POL-005 v1.4 (12 August 2023)

1. The probation period

All new employees serve a probation period of **90 calendar days** from their start date. The purpose of probation is to confirm that the role and the employee are a good fit for each other.

Probation may be extended once, by a maximum of 60 calendar days, where the line manager and People Operations agree that more time is needed to reach a decision. An extension must be communicated to the employee in writing before the original probation period ends.

2. Reviews during probation

- Day 30 check-in.** Informal. Line manager and employee discuss early progress. No written record is required.
- Day 60 review.** Written. The line manager records progress against the objectives set at induction and flags any concerns.
- Day 85 confirmation review.** Written. The line manager recommends confirmation, extension, or termination. People Operations must receive the recommendation no later than day 85 so that the employee can be notified before probation ends.

3. Notice periods

Notice requirements differ during and after probation. The applicable period is determined by the employee's status on the date notice is given.

Employment status	Notice required from employee	Notice required from company
During probation (including any extension)	7 calendar days, in writing	7 calendar days, in writing
Confirmed employee, below manager grade	30 calendar days, in writing	30 calendar days, in writing
Confirmed employee, manager grade and above	60 calendar days, in writing	60 calendar days, in writing

The company may elect to pay salary in lieu of notice. Notice given during probation does not require a reason to be stated, although one is normally given as a matter of good practice.

4. Leave during probation

Employees may take annual leave during probation, subject to the usual approval process in HR-POL-002. Annual leave continues to accrue throughout the probation period. Taking leave during probation does not extend the probation period.

5. Induction checklist

- Day 1 — equipment issued, accounts created, security briefing completed (see IT-POL-001).
- Day 1 — signed acknowledgement of the Employee Handbook filed with People Operations.
- Week 1 — objectives for the probation period agreed in writing with the line manager.

- Week 2 — introduction to the relevant finance and procurement processes (FIN-POL-003, PROC-PRO-002).

6. Confirmation

On successful completion of probation, People Operations issues a confirmation letter. Confirmation takes effect from the day after probation ends. Benefits that are conditional on confirmation, including the private medical scheme and the training allowance, become available on that date.